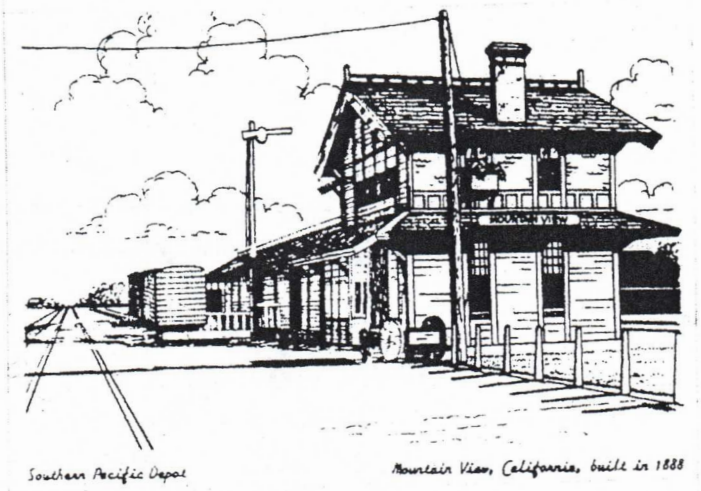
MAY 2007

Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042
Trudi Tuban - Editor



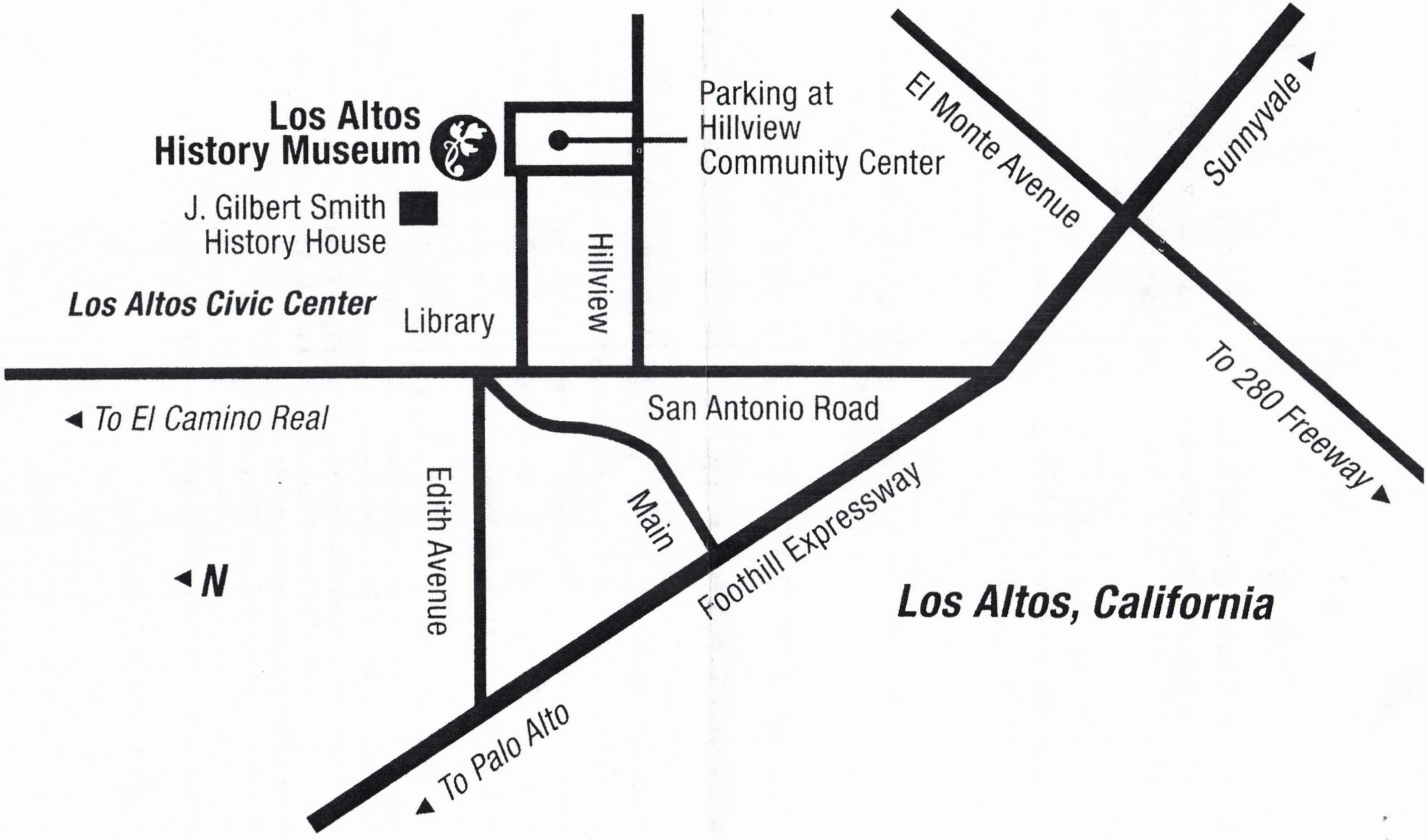
THIS MEETING IS AT THE LOS ALTOS HISTORY CENTER AT 10:00 AM, Sunday, May 6, 2007

--PLEASE NOTE TIME AND LOCATION CHANGE--

The Association of the Los Altos Historical Museum has invited us to visit their Museum in the Los Altos Civic Center. It will be an opportunity to learn how the Los Altos Museum evolved. The current exhibit, "Scene from Above," shows maps and aerial photos of the Los Altos and Mountain View area. Robert Grimm will tell the history of how the Los Altos Museum developed. He will unfold the success story of the Los Altos Museum which will be of value with our project to develop our own heritage center in Mountain View.

We will also have the opportunity to explore the museum attractions by taking a journey back in time with the Ohlone Indians, early California settlers, farmers and orchardists in the transformation from a portion of the "Valley of Hearts Delight" to the now culturally diverse community of Silicon Valley residents. There will be Docent led tours of the 1905 J. Gilbert Smith furnished house, historic gardens and the permanent exhibit gallery.

The Museum entrance and parking is at the rear of the library with facilities accessible from San Antonio Road or Hillview Avenue (please see map on page 2).


Los Altos
History Museum
J. Gilbert Smith
History House
Los Altos Civic Center
Library
Parking at
Hillview
Community Center
Hillview
El Monte Avenue
Sunnyvale
To 280 Freeway
To El Camino Real
San Antonio Road
Edith Avenue
Main
Foothill Expressway
N
To Palo Alto
Los Altos, California

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE BY ROBERT WEAVER

This is proving to be an exciting year for our association. The Los Altos History Museum has generously agreed to host our May meeting, and we are grateful indeed to have Mr. Robert Grimm as our speaker. Robert stands as a major force in the establishment of the Los Altos History Museum and has given generously of his time and talent in working with our museum committee. Please come, bring your family and friends and hear the story of the Los Altos Museum and enjoy its beauty. After our meeting, docents will be conducting tours of the museum, its grounds and the History House next door.

PLEASE MAKE NOTE OF THE LOCATION AND TIME CHANGE FOR THIS MEETING.

Sunnyvale Historical Association will soon break ground for their new museum. We were fortunate to meet with Laura Babcock, Association Chair, who shared a wealth of information with us regarding the establishment of their museum, a replica of the Murphy family home. With the help of our friends in Los Altos and Sunnyvale, the Mountain View Museum is off to a good start and on solid footing.

Long time museum supporters, Wallace and Ruth Erichsen, became the first to back up their convictions with a pledge of $10,000.00 to the museum fund! Rebecca Galiotto has also shown her support for the museum and pledged $5,000.00 as well! We are deeply grateful that your strong belief in the museum project are to be backed up by such generous financial contributions.

The Eagle Shack will soar again thanks to Eugene Sharp. For young people in post World War II Mountain View, the hot place to spend a Saturday night was the Adobe Building, known then as the Eagle Shack. Join your friends on Sunday, October 7, from 2 to 4, when the Eagle Shack returns. This event is the day after the high school reunion so the gang will be in town. Mark your calendars as dance cards are filling fast.

I am quite happy to report that Pat Figueroa, association Treasurer, is recuperating nicely at home after a stay in the hospital. Pat's absence brings to point the need for additional depth in our ranks. As the museum and other projects move forward, we will need new faces on the board and in our ranks to sustain the association. A few hours of time, four times a year is not a lot to ask, and the same few who carry the load now can have back-up. Please volunteer to help at the meetings or go for a seat on the board.

As you can see, this is going to be an exciting year for the Mountain View Historical Association.

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

100 Years Ago (1907):

"About three miles west of the town of Mountain View, in one of the most beautiful spots in the Santa Clara Valley, is to be built a new town, to be called Los Altos. Situated at an elevation of 225 feet above sea level, partly in the valley and partly in the foothills, commanding a charming view of the Bay of San Francisco on the north and the evergreen Coast Range Mountains on the south, with the oak-dotted valley extending to the east and west, is to be established a town that will be the Pasadena of Central California."

75 Years ago (1932):

California Supply (Pickle Works) is now producing sauerkraut in its new building which has 40 tanks, each with a capacity of 2,000 gallons. Mr. Otto Uhrhammer is in charge with 20 men under his direction.

A large and colorful flashing neon sign was installed at the theatre on Castro Street identifying it as BLANCO'S THEATRE.

Between 6 and 7 pm on Friday, May 13, 1932, the world's largest airship moored at the Naval Air Station, Mountain View. Built by Goodyear Zeppelin Corporation, Akron, Ohio, the dirigible was christened the USS Akron by Mrs. Herbert Hoover. Over the several days the Akron was here, crowds of people came to see it and the local newspaper reported it was "the largest collection of cars that has ever been at any one place at one time in California, or on the whole West Coast." In spite of the numbers, refreshment stands did not have the business they had expected, neither did the downtown merchants.

50 YEARS AGO (1957):

In April 1957, there were two special grand openings: The Crossroads and the Sears store, both located near San Antonio Road and El Camino Real. Lt. Robert Schatz of the Mountain View Police Department was in charge of crowd control, directed 50 officers from Mountain View and neighboring cities.

Sakura Gardens, a unique and beautiful Japanese restaurant, opened at 2116 El Camino Real. Roy Watanabe was the Architect and George Tsukagama the Manager. The garden and fish pond was designed by Nagao Sakura, Head Landscape Architect for 20 years at the Japanese Imperial Palace.

25 YEARS AGO (1982):

Marine World Africa USA, Redwood City, is looking at land in the North Bayshore area for a larger park.

The restored Mockbee building, on the North East corner of Castro and Villa Streets, was recognized by the Santa Clara County Historical Heritage Commission with its Award of Excellence.

STREET TALK BY BARBARA KINCHEN

Someone inquired about the origin of the street where he lives -- Thompson Avenue, between Central Expressway and Middlefield Road. At one time, Thompson Avenue was part of Calderon Road. (Do not confuse this with our present Calderon Avenue.) By 1950, this part of Calderon Road from El Camino Real to the railroad tracks was renamed Ortega Avenue. But, an 1952-53 map still showed Calderon Road north of the tracks. Monta Loma School opened in 1956 on Thompson Avenue.

So who was Thompson and who were the side streets named for? Jane, Jewel, Lida, Laura, Louis and Adele?

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW LIBRARY'S HISTORY CENTER

Given by member Kevin Duggan: (1) Not dated, four-page newspaper article with many photos of future blimp pilots training in balloons at Moffett Field. (2) Small, one-inch in diameter, souvenir pin promoting Mountain View's Prune and Apricot Exposition, September 21-22, 1917. A young lady is shown on a ladder picking fruit.

THE EAGLE SHACK IS BACK BY EUGENE SHARP

"The Eagle Shack is Back" is scheduled for October 7, 2007, from 2 to 4 pm, at the Adobe Building. We plan a short presentation of Eagle Shack history and then dancing and other typical Eagle Shack activities. Some of the original "Melody Mixers" plan to play in the dance band and we hope to add other local musicians who are string players to possibly make up an orchestra. If you have any memories of the Eagle Shack that you might want to share, no matter how trivial, please contact Eugene Sharp at 650-493-1488 or esharp_f@pacbell.net. One question is "What was behind the double doors where several fellows would venture behind during the evening? We would also appreciate knowing how to locate a copy of "Eagle Shack" (as mentioned in the last Newsletter), which was written in 1949, of which 2,800 copies were sent statewide.

NOTE: Anyone, who is not presently a member and would like to receive updated information usually found in the Newsletter, please consider joining the MVHA using the form on the back page of this Newsletter.

ASSOCIATION OFFICERS AND EXECUTIVE COMMITTEE

President	Robert Weaver
Vice President	Vivian Schatz
Sergeant at Arms	Craig Holden
Secretary	Margaret Peterson
Treasurer	Pat Figueroa
Past President	Nick Galiotto
Editor	Trudi Tuban
Membership	June Casey
Programs & Publicity **	Wally Erichsen
Hospitality	Laura Brown
Memorials & Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Ways & Means	Hip Telmont
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification & Recording	Al Jehning

** *NOTE: We are looking for someone to take over Programs and Publicity. The position may also possibly be split*

MEMBERSHIP REPORT BY JUNE CASEY

A/S = Single Members	111
A/F = Family Members	118
LM = Life Members	124
HM = Honored Member	2 = 355 TOTAL

New A/S Member: Barbara (Cousins) Holgate
New Life Members: Pauline Mardesich King,

Deceased Members: Manuel Martin, Nancie Lou King Smith, Helen Roberta Bubb Sweeney and Glenn (Hank) Eastwood Wilson

IN MEMORIAM

MANUEL GIL MARTIN died on March 4, 2007 at the age of 82. He is survived by his wife, Donna; sons Richard, Robert and Ronald; brothers Joe, Jim, Frank, Louis and sister Carmen Rebollo. He was predeceased by his sister Isabel Gonzales and his brother Sal Martin. Manuel was born in Santa Clara and graduated from Mountain View Union High School in 1944. He was a member of the MVHA.

NANCY LOU KING SMITH died May 6, 2006 at the age of 66. She is survived by her husband Richard M. Smith. Nancy Lou graduated from Mountain View High School in 1957. She was a life member of the MVHA.

HELEN ROBERTA BUBB SWEENEY, born April 18, 1913, passed away January 8, 2007. She is survived by her husband Joseph, two sons John and Paul and was inurned at St. Timothy's Episcopal Church Columbarium. She was a member of the pioneering Bubb family (Bubb school and Bubb Park) and was the President of the MVHA in 1988.

GLENN 'HANK' EASTWOOD WILSON passed away on December 22, 2006. He was predeceased by his parents Mary and Glenn Wilson, his brother William and his first wife, Ina Wilson. He is survived by his wife Connie Mariottini and daughters Darley Jeppson and Deborah and Kelly Wilson. Hank was a graduate of Mountain View High School and San Jose State College (University). He was a member of the California Air National Guard. Hank succeeded his father as President of Valley Electric Company. He was past president of the Mountain View Chamber of Commerce, member of the Rotary Club, the Elks Lodge and The MVHA.

Mountain View

Historical

Association

SPECIAL LOCATION/TIME

MEETING AT THE

LOS ALTOS HISTORY

MUSEUM

Sunday, 5/6/2007 @ 10 AM

On Hillview

See Enclosed Map

Membership: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

Aims: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME:

ADDRESS:

TELEPHONE:

TYPE: NEW_____ RENEWAL_____

Regular Member $10/year
Family Membership $15/year
Life Member $200.00

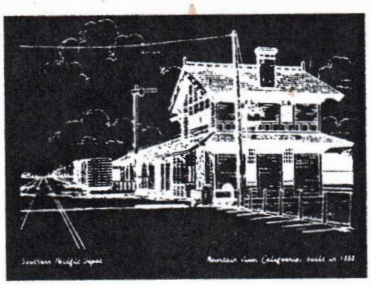
Make Check Payable to:

Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

Mountain View
Historical Association
P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

UNITED STATES POSTAGE PITNEY BOWES
02 1P $ 00.39⁰
0002417205 APR 20 2007
MAILED FROM ZIP CODE 94043

first class mail



)08

94041⁸1942 C053